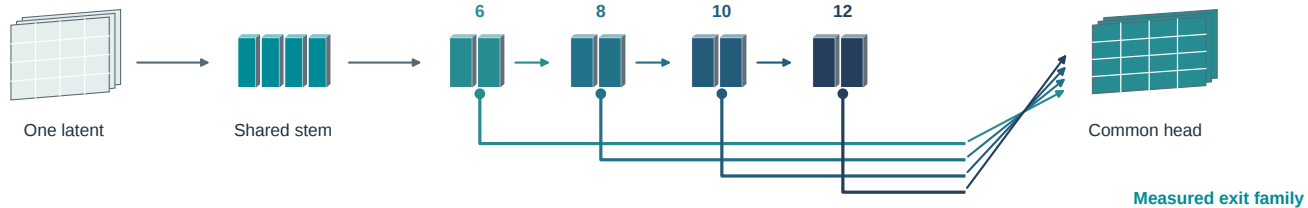


a Shared early exit: one representation, nested synthesis



b Independent depth controls: each codec learns its own representation



c Later routing study: select before encoding; signal which expert owns the payload

